



GENERIC OUTLINE

Generic 3-minute public comment outline

About 2.8 min at ~140 words/min · 388 words · Replace [Your Name]. Prefer a focused script from the speech picker when you can.

Good evening, Mayor Crawford, members of Council. Thank you for your time.

My name is [Your Name], and I live in Crossville. I am here about the City's Flock Safety automated license plate readers, the cameras that log our vehicles' movements. These cameras scan every passing plate. That usually does not require a warrant unless the city writes stricter rules.

Public records show Crossville Police subscribed to Flock Falcon cameras in 2022. Vendor Quote Q-00234 proposed 10 cameras and about \$25,000 a year in recurring fees. That quote is a non-binding proposal, not an invoice. As of July 2026, I have not found a city-published search policy or official public camera map.

I support public safety. I also support oversight. These systems are marketed as crime tools. The downside risk falls on Crossville taxpayers if something goes wrong.

Tennessee already has documented problems with this technology. In Oak Ridge, a former officer pleaded guilty and was sentenced after using Flock 18 times for personal searches, not for law enforcement. In Morristown, Business Insider's police-records reporting describes a Flock alert that helped trigger a gunpoint stop after a plate was misread, with guns drawn and adults handcuffed. Nationally, researchers have catalogued dozens of officer-misuse cases and wrongful ALPR stops, including settlements into the hundreds of thousands and, in one ALPR case in Aurora, about \$1.9 million. That Aurora settlement was not a Flock-branded product, but it shows what ALPR errors can cost taxpayers.

Tennessee's ALPR retention statute limits how long data is kept. It is a storage cap, not a grant of immunity from federal civil-rights claims if a bad stop or misuse is later alleged. Flock typically leases the cameras as a subscription service and keeps ownership of the hardware. Taxpayers still pay the bills and any settlements.

My ask is clear. Cancel Crossville's Flock contract and remove the cameras. Require a public hearing and a recorded City Council vote before any surveillance equipment is ever proposed again. If you will not cancel yet, take a recorded yes-or-no vote each year before any renewal, with no automatic renewal that skips a public vote, and publish monthly use reports the public can check, along with a written search policy and a public camera map.

Thank you. I yield.